

Ana Lu

Financial & Systems Accountant
Sydney

Provisional Member, CA ANZ · CA due 2027

Financial accountant who fixes the system, not just the numbers.

Full-suite: 3.5 years owning the whole cycle end to end, from AR and month-end to AASB statutory reporting for a $500m+ scheme. Plus a systems analyst's eye for automating the menial work away.

`Problem` → `Root cause` → `Automate` → `Result`

Financial Reporting · Statutory Compliance · ERP Systems · Data & App Architecture · Data Analytics · Agentic AI · Automation · BI & Excel Expert · Python, React & SQL

Also known for patience, and for being fun to be around.

Achievements

Before → after, at a $500m+ statutory reporting scheme.

~~60~~ → 2

Auditor sample requests a month

Prepared audit-ready month-end working papers. No audit challenges in the years after.

~~100%~~ → 50%

Finance processing time

Automated Oracle matching and rebuilt fragile spreadsheets across month-end, audit, bank recs and AR/AP.

$50K

ERP upgrade approved by the board in three months

Wrote the business case for payment reminders, debt collection and BI reporting.

~~4 h~~ → ~1 h

Manual receipt matching a day

Found Oracle's auto-match, unused for five years, in my second week.

Work history

Financial Accountant
Sircel Limited · Jul 2026 – Sep 2026

Assistant Financial Accountant
Exchange for Change · Nov 2022 – Mar 2026

Accountant
Fifty Frames · Feb 2020 – Nov 2022

Systems Analyst
ITPLUS Communications · Oct 2015 – Jul 2019

Assistant Store Manager
Jay Jays · Jul 2014 – Oct 2015

Business Development Officer
ITPLUS Communications · Sep 2013 – Jul 2014

Sales Assistant
Just Jeans · Oct 2012 – Sep 2013

Achievements, in detail

Each one follows the same path: find the problem, dig to the root cause, fix the system, then measure the result.

~~60~~ → 2

Making the auditors' job easy

Exchange for Change · Return and Earn (NSW) and ACT container deposit schemes

PROBLEM

In my first year I supplied thousands of documents to external audit. Every request pulled me away from month-end, and every answer had to be dug out by hand.

ROOT CAUSE

Auditors weren't asking because something was wrong. They were asking because our month-end work didn't answer their questions up front, so they had to sample to get comfortable.

WHAT I DID

I made it my mission to prepare month-end work that answered the auditors' questions before they asked them.

RESULT

AR sample requests fell from around 60 a month to a couple in year two.

In the years after, the auditors didn't challenge my work, because they trusted it.

~~100%~~ → 50%

A $50m workflow still running at $500m

Exchange for Change

PROBLEM

The bank rec workbook had been maintained since day one. It took 20 minutes to open, broke constantly and held thousands of transactions a month. It also fed cash flow and debt-collection reporting.

Every export meant manually fixing around 50 customer names back to their registered names. The prepayments workbook held thousands of lines from machines across the state, with no validation: wrong dates, wrong quantities, a new surprise every month.

ROOT CAUSE

The workflow was designed when the scheme turned over about $50m a year. Five years later it was processing $500m+ on the same spreadsheets, and nobody had been given the time to rebuild them.

WHAT I DID

Where the ERP couldn't do something easily or cheaply, I built financial models that turned raw exports into reports without touching the source data.

RESULT

Time spent on month-end, external audit, bank recs and AR/AP processing fell by more than half.

The team got so much time back that people forgot how much work Finance actually does.

$50K

Winning $50K for a long-neglected Finance team

Exchange for Change

PROBLEM

Finance had been running on an under-configured Oracle ERP for years. Even a single invoice template change usually cost $10K to $20K, so small fixes never happened.

ROOT CAUSE

Finance had never put its case to the IT committee and the board in their terms: what it costs the scheme to leave things as they are.

WHAT I DID

Three months into the job, I wrote my first full business case, convincing the IT committee and the board that a long-neglected Finance team was worth investing in.

RESULT

We delivered payment reminders, a fixed debt-collection module and custom Oracle BI report training for the $50K.

~~4 h~~ → ~1 h

1,000+ clicks a day, cut to about an hour

Exchange for Change

PROBLEM

Bank recs and receipting ate most of the day. We spent around four hours a day clicking 1,000+ times to match receipts to invoices, one at a time. One day I reconciled 200+ transactions by hand.

ROOT CAUSE

By the end of week one I'd worked out that we weren't using our tools, we were working around them. An ERP of that calibre was never meant to be run by hand.

WHAT I DID

In week two I dug through the (famously unhelpful) Oracle manuals and found the auto-match command that nobody had used in the company's five years.

RESULT

Manual matching down from around four hours a day to about one hour, now spent only on the exceptions.

It's also the moment I knew I'd stay.

Education & training

An accountant trained in computer science, now completing the Chartered Accountants program.

Professional membership

Provisional Member, Chartered Accountants ANZ

Chartered Accountants Australia and New Zealand (CA ANZ)

Aug 2023 – Dec 2027 · CA Program in progress

Graduate Diploma of Chartered Accounting. On track for full Chartered Accountant (CA) membership.

DEGREES

Bachelor of Accountancy, Accounting and Finance
Massey University, Te Kunenga ki Pūrehuroa · 2020 – 2023

Bachelor of Computer and Information Sciences, IT Service Science
Auckland University of Technology (AUT) · 2014 – 2017

FORMAL TRAINING & CERTIFICATES

Dynamics 365 Finance, 7 badges

Microsoft Learn · Nov 2025 – Jun 2026

Module assessments passed

Core capabilities, general ledger, AP and AR, expense, fixed assets and budgeting, and finance and operations apps.

Microsoft Power BI

Nexacu

Formal training in data modelling, DAX and reporting.

Microsoft Excel, Expert

Nexacu

Formal training in advanced modelling, Power Query and automation.

MYOB Essentials

MYOB

Certificate of Completion

Skills & tech stack

No self-rated bars. Each skill comes with where I've used it.

3.5 years, owned end to end

Full-suite financial accountant

- Accounts receivable
- Reconciliations
- Management reports
- P&L, balance sheet & cash flow statement
- External audits
- Government reporting
- BAS & payroll tax
- Month-end close
- Financial reporting
- Cashflow management & reporting
- Statutory reporting (AASB / IFRS)
- Multi-entity accounting
- Payroll
- Statutory obligations

Formal qualifications, including CA ANZ, are on **Education & training →**

My hobbies include designing an ERP, **HRT Systems →**

FINANCE & REPORTING

AASB statutory reporting
Statutory reporting for a $500m+ scheme

Statutory compliance
Kept a regulated scheme audit-ready

Month-end close & reconciliations
Automated bank matching: 4 h a day to about 1 h

Audit support
Cut audit samples from 60 to 2

Business cases
Built the $50K ERP upgrade case

ERP IMPLEMENTATION

Oracle Fusion ERP
- Configured the Collections module myself: delinquency tracking, promise-to-pay and collector notes
- FBDI bulk loads: manual journals, customer uploads and mass updates
- Bank statement auto-match set-up (4 h a day to about 1 h)
- Oracle BI report training

Microsoft Dynamics 365 Finance
7 Microsoft Learn badges: GL, AP/AR, fixed assets, budgeting

NetSuite
Led the implementation end to end, with minimal partner help (reference on request)

Xero
Implemented for a production company

MYOB
Implemented, plus MYOB Essentials certificate

Unleashed & DEAR Systems (now Cin7 Core)
Inventory system migrations

DATA & BI

Power BI & DAX
Formal training with Nexacu

Excel, expert level
Formal training with Nexacu

Power Query
Repeatable data clean-up instead of manual fixes

SQL
Extracting and reconciling ERP data

AUTOMATION & CODE

Python
Financial modelling and automation scripts

React
Custom reporting tools, and this site

Agentic AI
AI agents that do the menial work

Docker
Self-hosting open-source tools

Nocobase & Frappe
Custom reporting apps on open-source platforms

WordPress, Joomla, Drupal & Payload CMS
Built cleanuppartners.com.au (WordPress) and this website (Next.js)

SOFTWARE ENGINEERING

Spec-first development

- Full SDLC docs before code: requirements, architecture, data schema, security, API and UI/UX
- Coding standards, development workflow and deployment guides

Database design (PostgreSQL)

Multi-tenant ERP schema with dimensional chart of accounts

Containers & deployment

Dockerised Next.js builds

Object-oriented programming

Java, C#, C++ and Ruby: formal study at AUT, plus hobby projects

AI & DEV TOOLS

Claude Code

Agentic coding across full projects

Antigravity IDE & VS Code

Day-to-day development environments

Google AI Studio

Prototyping with Gemini models

Perplexity

Sourced research

SYSTEMS & ARCHITECTURE

Data & app architecture

Bridging finance and IT on ERP projects

Systems analysis

Systems Analyst at ITPLUS, 2015 to 2019

Process redesign

Root cause first, then automate

IT INFRASTRUCTURE

Networking
Surveillance and network installs at ITPLUS

Server builds & configuration
Built and configured servers for customers

Firmware coding
Wrote firmware for hardware products

DOCUMENTATION & TRAINING

Technical manuals
Written for IT products and systems

Policies & procedures
Finance and IT processes, written down so they last

Training in IT & finance
Teaching teams the systems and the accounting behind them

Open to FA, MA, Commercial Analyst & FP&A roles · Sydney

Hire me 😊

Need someone who can close the month, explain the numbers and fix the system that makes it slow? Let's talk.

Email me | LinkedIn

Email ana.lu@radicaltg.com

References Available on request